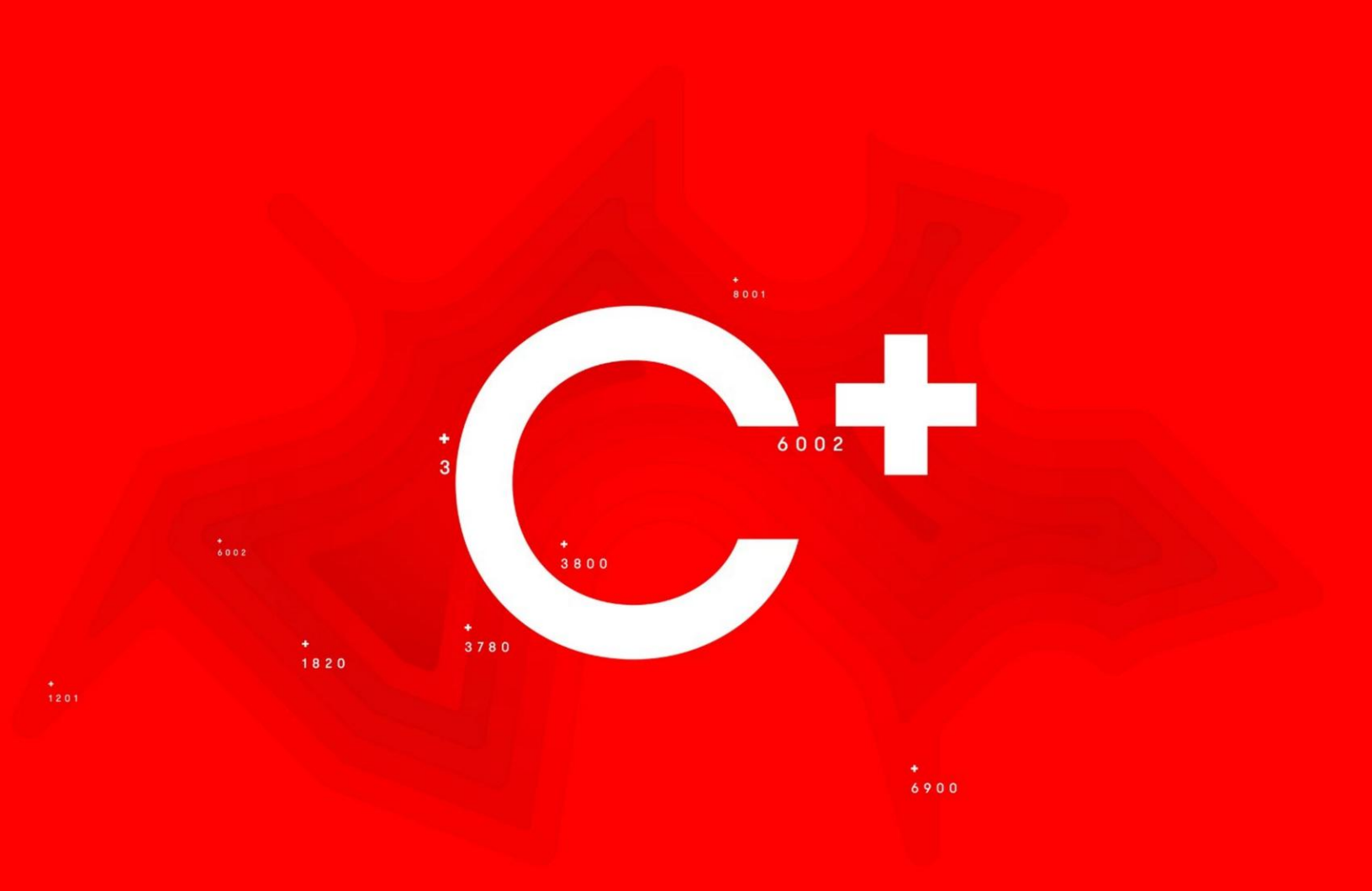

Drink Preparation

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Introduction

This guide is your reference for preparing every drink on the **C+ menu**. Each recipe includes the exact parameters, cup or glass assignment, and step-by-step technique. Consistency is a cornerstone of our craft — every guest should receive the same quality, whether it is their first visit or their hundredth.

> **Recipes Are Starting Points**
>
> The recipes in this guide represent our current standard. Coffee is a living product — variables like roast age, origin, and ambient humidity can affect extraction. Use these parameters as your baseline, but always **taste critically** and **dial in** before service. If something tastes off, adjust. A recipe that is followed blindly is no better than no recipe at all.

All espresso-based drinks at C+ are built on a **double shot** pulling **36 g** in the cup. The espresso is the foundation — if the shot is not dialled in, no amount of milk or technique will save the drink.

Cups & Glassware

Using the correct vessel is part of the C+ standard. Each drink has a designated cup or glass for dine-in and a specific take-away cup. The photo below shows the full lineup.

Full cup lineup at C+. Left: take-away cups (red paper in three sizes + clear plastic). Right: dine-in cups (large and small beige ceramic, blue glass).

Dine-In

Drink	Vessel
C+ Extraction	Small beige cup
Americano	Small beige cup
Macchiato	Small beige cup
Cortado	Small beige cup
Flat White	Large beige cup
Cappuccino	Large beige cup
Swiss Mocca	Large beige cup
Latte	Blue glass
Seasonal Latte	Blue glass
Matcha	Blue glass
Golden Latte	Blue glass
V60	V60 carafe
Cold Brew	Glass with ice

Take Away

Only **red paper cups** and the **clear plastic cup** are used for take away. The preparation is identical — only the vessel changes.

Drink	Take-Away Cup
C+ Extraction	Small red cup
Macchiato	Small red cup
Cortado	Small red cup

Drink	Take-Away Cup
Americano	Medium red cup
Flat White	Medium red cup
Swiss Mocca	Medium red cup
Matcha	Medium red cup
Golden Latte	Medium red cup
Cappuccino	Large red cup
Latte	Large red cup
Seasonal Latte	Large red cup
V60	Large red cup
Cold Brew	Clear plastic cup

When in Doubt, Check the Photo

If you are unsure which cup to use, refer to the photo above or ask a colleague. Using the wrong vessel affects the drink experience and is not acceptable.

1. Espresso-Based Drinks

Every espresso drink at C+ starts with a **double shot** yielding **36 g** in the cup. The quality of the espresso is non-negotiable — always taste your shot before service and dial in at the start of each session. The differences between drinks come down to **milk texture**, **ratios**, and **vessel**.

For the full theory behind extraction, pressure profiling, and dialling in, refer to the **C+ Espresso & Milk Training Manual**. This section covers the step-by-step preparation workflow for each drink.

The C+ Espresso Workflow

The following 10-step protocol applies to **every espresso-based drink** at C+. It must be followed precisely, regardless of the drink being prepared. The recipe parameters are: **18 g dose 36 g beverage weight** (1:2 ratio), within **25–35 seconds**.

Step 1 — Spray (RDT)

Weigh **18.0 g** of whole beans on the **Subminimal Subscale** (±0.1 g). Apply one spray of RDT to the beans to control static.

Step 2 — Grind

Transfer the beans to the **Weber EG-1** hopper. Grind directly into the dosing cup. The low-retention design ensures virtually all the weighed coffee reaches the cup.

Step 3 — Shake

Transfer the grounds to the **Weber Blind Shaker**. Shake briefly (3–4 times) to break up clumps and homogenise the particle distribution.

Step 4 — Navigator

Pour the grounds from the Blind Shaker into the portafilter basket. Use the **PUQ Prep Navigator** for automatic WDT distribution, ensuring even distribution across the basket and preventing channelling.

Step 5 — Distribute

Use the **Normcore Coffee Gravity Distributor** to level the coffee bed after the Navigator. This creates a perfectly flat, uniform surface ready for tamping.

Step 6 — Tamp

Apply firm, even pressure straight down using the **Weber Really Nice Tamper**. Do not twist or polish. The goal is a flat, uniformly compressed coffee bed.

Step 7 — Air Blow

Use a small air blower to remove any loose grounds from the portafilter rim and basket edges. This prevents stray grounds from compromising the group head seal.

Step 8 — Scale Setup

Position the **Acaia Lunar** scale beneath the cup. Tare the scale to zero.

Step 9 — Extract

Insert the portafilter into the group head and start the extraction. Monitor both time and beverage weight in real time. Target **36 g** of beverage weight within **25–35 seconds**.

Step 10 — Flush & Clean

After extraction, flush the group head with water and thoroughly clean the portafilter, both internally and externally. Use the water from the machine's flushing cycle for cleaning the portafilter.

> **The Golden Rule**
>
> Never serve a channelled shot. If you see uneven, watery, or squirting flow from a naked portafilter, or turbulent, transparent streams from a spouted portafilter, **discard the shot and remake it**.

1.1 C+ Extraction

Vessel: Small beige cup

The C+ Extraction is our straight espresso — no milk, no additions. This is the purest expression of the coffee and the barista's craft. Follow the 10-step espresso workflow above, serve in the small beige cup on a saucer. Espresso degrades quickly — it should reach the guest within seconds of extraction.

1.2 Americano

Vessel: Small beige cup

Our Americano uses the **long black** technique: hot water goes into the cup first, and the espresso is pulled on top. This preserves the crema and delivers a more aromatic, layered cup compared to pouring water over the shot.

Step 1 — Hot Water

Add **110 g** of hot water to the small beige cup.

Step 2 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull the double shot (**36 g**) directly on top of the water. The crema will float on the surface.

Step 3 — Serve

Serve immediately. Do not stir — let the guest decide whether to blend the layers.

1.3 Macchiato

Vessel: Small beige cup

A macchiato is espresso "stained" with a small dot of milk foam. It is not a mini latte — the milk is a garnish, not a component.

Step 1 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) into the small beige cup.

Step 2 — Add Foam

Using a spoon or a gentle pour, place a small dot of textured milk foam on top of the crema. The milk should be barely visible.

Step 3 — Serve

Serve promptly on a saucer.

1.4 Cortado

Vessel: Small beige cup

The cortado balances espresso and milk at a **1:1 ratio**. The milk is textured but not overly foamy — silky and integrated.

Step 1 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) into the small beige cup.

Step 2 — Texture Milk

Steam a small amount of milk. Keep it **silky and flat** — minimal foam. The stretching phase should be very brief.

Step 3 — Pour

Pour textured milk to roughly equal the volume of espresso. A simple centered pour is sufficient — latte art is optional but welcome.

1.5 Flat White

Vessel: Large beige cup

The flat white is a milk drink with a **thin microfoam layer** and strong coffee presence. The milk is stretched for only **2 seconds**, producing a velvety texture with almost no visible foam on top.

Step 1 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) into the large beige cup.

Step 2 — Texture Milk

Steam milk with the steam tip just below the surface. Stretch for **2 seconds** only, then submerge and heat to approximately **55–65°C**. Do not incorporate air while the milk is still cold — begin aerating only once the temperature has risen above **37°C** to avoid the destructive effect of solid fat crystals on foam structure. The milk should be glossy and free of visible bubbles.

Step 3 — Pour

Pour with a steady, centered stream. Finish with latte art. The drink should have a thin, flat layer of microfoam — not a domed cap.

1.6 Cappuccino

Vessel: Large beige cup

The cappuccino has a **thicker foam layer** than the flat white, created by stretching for **4 seconds**. It should feel light and airy on the palate while still delivering strong coffee flavour.

Step 1 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) into the large beige cup.

Step 2 — Texture Milk

Steam milk with the tip just below the surface. Stretch for **4 seconds** to incorporate more air, then submerge and heat to approximately **55–65°C**. Remember: do not incorporate air while the milk is still cold (below 37°C). The milk should be thick and creamy with a visible foam layer.

Step 3 — Pour

Pour with a higher starting position, then drop close for latte art. The finished drink should have a pronounced, slightly domed foam cap.

1.7 Latte

Vessel: Blue glass

The latte is our most approachable milk drink — a generous amount of silky milk with espresso. Stretched for **3 seconds**, it sits between the flat white and cappuccino in foam volume.

Step 1 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) into the blue glass.

Step 2 — Texture Milk

Steam milk, stretching for **3 seconds**. Heat to **55–65°C**. The texture should be smooth and slightly creamy but not as thick as a cappuccino.

Step 3 — Pour

Pour a steady, centered stream into the glass. Finish with latte art. The milk-to-coffee ratio is the highest of our espresso drinks.

1.8 Seasonal Latte

Vessel: Blue glass

The seasonal latte adds **40 g of homemade syrup** (vanilla or cinnamon, depending on the season) to the standard latte build. The syrup is made in-house — never use commercial syrups.

Step 1 — Add Syrup

Pour **40 g** of the current seasonal syrup into the blue glass.

Step 2 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) directly into the glass, on top of the syrup.

Step 3 — Texture Milk

Steam milk with **3 seconds** of stretching to **55–65°C** — same as a standard latte.

Step 4 — Pour & Mix

Pour the milk into the glass. The pouring action will integrate the syrup. A gentle stir may be needed if the syrup settles at the bottom.

1.9 Swiss Mocca

Vessel: Large beige cup

The Swiss Mocca combines espresso with **20 g of chocolate buttons**, melted and integrated before adding milk. It is not a mocha made with cocoa powder or syrup — we use real chocolate for depth and richness.

Step 1 — Prepare Chocolate

Place **20 g of chocolate buttons** into the large beige cup.

Step 2 — Extract Espresso

Follow the 10-step espresso workflow. Pull a double shot (**36 g**) directly onto the chocolate. The heat of the espresso will begin melting the buttons.

Step 3 — Mix

Stir the espresso and chocolate thoroughly until the chocolate is fully dissolved and the mixture is smooth and homogeneous.

Step 4 — Texture Milk

Steam milk with **3 seconds** of stretching to **55–65°C** — latte texture.

Step 5 — Pour

Pour the textured milk into the chocolate-espresso base. Latte art is optional but adds a nice finishing touch.

Milk Steaming Reference

Phase 1 — Aeration (Stretching): Position the steam wand tip so it is 'kissing' the surface of the milk — just barely submerged. Do **not** incorporate air while the milk is still cold: begin aerating only once the temperature has risen above **37°C** to avoid the destructive effect of solid fat crystals on foam structure.

Flat White: 2 seconds stretching — thin, velvety microfoam
Latte / Seasonal Latte / Swiss Mocca: 3 seconds — smooth, lightly creamy
Cappuccino: 4 seconds — thick, airy foam with a pronounced cap

Phase 2 — Texturing (Heating): Once the desired volume increase is achieved, submerge the wand deeper and continue heating without adding more air.

Standard drinks: 55–65°C
Extra hot (customer request): 65–70°C maximum

Drink temperatures above 70°C scald the tongue. Digital temperature probes have a 2–3°C lag — account for this when shutting off the steam. With practice, your fingertips on the pitcher become a reliable gauge: when the pitcher becomes too hot to hold comfortably, you are at approximately 55–60°C.

Never re-steam milk. Discard any leftover milk between drinks.

Milk Waste Is Unacceptable

Before steaming, **estimate the amount of milk you actually need** for the drink you are preparing. Pouring too much milk into the jug means the excess goes straight into the bin — that is money and product wasted on every single drink. Learn the volume of each vessel: a cortado needs far less milk than a latte. With practice, you should finish each pour with **little to no milk left in the jug**. If you consistently have large amounts of leftover milk, you are using too much. Adjust and be precise.

2. No-Coffee Drinks

These drinks contain no coffee but follow the same standards of care and consistency. The key technique is **pre-mixing the powder with hot water** and using a matcha whisk to eliminate clumps before adding milk.

2.1 Matcha

Vessel: Blue glass

Our matcha is made with **1.5 g** of ceremonial-grade matcha powder. The powder must be whisked with water first to ensure a smooth, clump-free base.

Step 1 — Prepare Matcha Paste

Place **1.5 g of matcha** into a small bowl or the glass itself. Add approximately **25 ml of hot water** (not boiling — around 80°C is ideal).

Step 2 — Whisk

Use the **matcha whisk (chasen)** with fast, small movements in an **"M" or "W" pattern** — not a circular motion. Whisk vigorously until all clumps are dissolved and the mixture is smooth with a light froth on top.

Step 3 — Texture Milk

Steam milk to approximately **55–65°C** with a latte-style texture.

Step 4 — Combine & Serve

Pour the matcha paste into the blue glass (if not already there), then pour the textured milk on top. The result should be a vibrant green drink with no visible clumps.

2.2 Golden Latte

Vessel: Blue glass

The golden latte uses **1.5 g of turmeric blend** prepared the same way as matcha — whisked with hot water before adding milk.

Step 1 — Prepare Turmeric Paste

Place **1.5 g of turmeric blend** into a small bowl or the glass. Add approximately **25 ml of hot water**.

Step 2 — Whisk

Use the **matcha whisk** with fast, small movements in an **"M" or "W" pattern** — not a circular motion. Mix thoroughly until smooth and clump-free.

Step 3 — Texture Milk

Steam milk to approximately **55–65°C** with a latte-style texture.

Step 4 — Combine & Serve

Pour the turmeric paste into the blue glass, then pour the textured milk on top. The drink should have a warm golden colour throughout.

Why Whisk First?

Both matcha and turmeric powders are hydrophobic — they resist mixing with liquid. Adding them directly to milk creates stubborn clumps that ruin the texture and appearance of the drink. Whisking with a small amount of hot water first creates a smooth paste that integrates seamlessly with the steamed milk.

3. Filter Coffee

For detailed brewing science and technique, refer to the **C+ Filter Coffee Manual**. This section provides the essential recipe parameters for quick reference during service.

Note: Full V60 technique, water quality, and troubleshooting guidance are covered in the dedicated Filter Coffee Manual.

3.1 V60 — 2 Pax (Asaad's Recipe)

Vessel: V60 carafe

Parameter	Value
Coffee	15 g
Water	240 ml
Ratio	1:16
Bloom Temperature	88°C
Pour Temperature	92°C
Grind	Medium-fine (EG-1 ~6.5–7)
Target Brew Time	2:20–2:40

Step 1 — Prepare

Place the V60 or Kinto OCT on the server, insert filter paper, and rinse with hot water from the **Fellow Stagg EKG Pro**. Discard the rinse water. Place on the **MHW-3BOMBER scale** and tare.

Step 2 — Dose

Weigh **15.0 g** of coffee (±0.1 g). Grind into the brewer. Level the bed with a gentle shake.

Step 3 — Bloom (0:00–0:45)

Pour **45 g** of water at **88°C** in a gentle spiral from centre outward. Gentle swirl once. The lower bloom temperature preserves delicate floral and aromatic compounds. Wait 45 seconds.

Step 4 — First Pour (0:45–1:15)

Pour to **120 g** total at **92°C**. Slow spiral, low turbulence. This phase targets sweetness and clarity.

Step 5 — Second Pour (1:15–1:45)

Pour to **200 g** total. Slightly increased flow. This phase builds body without heaviness.

Step 6 — Final Pour (1:45–2:00)

Pour to **240 g** total. Centre pour only — no spiral. This produces a clean finish and structure.

Step 7 — Drawdown

Allow the water to drain completely. Target finish: **2:20–2:40**. A flat bed at the end indicates proper technique and even extraction.

Step 8 — Serve

Swirl the server to homogenise the brew. Serve immediately.

3.2 V60 — 4 Pax

Vessel: V60 carafe

Parameter	Value
Coffee	40 g

Parameter	Value
Water	480 ml
Ratio	1:12
Bloom Temperature	88°C
Pour Temperature	92°C
Grind	Medium (coarser than 2 pax)
Target Brew Time	Adjusted for deeper bed

Follow the same staged pour technique as the 2 pax recipe, adapted for the larger dose. Grind **coarser** to compensate for the deeper coffee bed. The bloom uses **88°C** water; all subsequent pours use **92°C**. The higher dose means water takes longer to pass through the grounds — a coarser grind prevents over-extraction and bitterness. Scale the pour stages proportionally (bloom at ~80 g, then stage to 480 g total).

Scaling V60 Recipes

When scaling up from 2 pax to 4 pax, the ratio shifts from 1:16 to approximately 1:12. This is intentional — with a larger dose and deeper bed, the contact time increases significantly. A slightly lower ratio and coarser grind maintain balance. Always taste and adjust.

4. Cold Drinks

Cold brew at C+ is prepared in batches and requires advance planning. It is a slow extraction method — patience and consistency yield the best results.

4.1 Seasonal Cold Brew

Vessel: Glass with ice

Parameter	Value
Coffee	125 g
Water	1 L (filtered, room temperature)
Ratio	1:8

Parameter	Value
Grind	Coarse (EG-1 dial ~20–22)
Steep Time	12 hours in the fridge

Step 1 — Grind

Grind **125 g** of coffee on the EG-1 at a coarse setting (dial **20–22**, approximately 1000–1200 microns). The grind should be visibly coarse, similar to raw sugar.

Step 2 — Combine

Add the ground coffee to the cold brew brewer (1 L capacity). Pour **1 litre of filtered water at room temperature** over the grounds. Stir gently to ensure all grounds are saturated.

Step 3 — Steep

Place the brewer in the **fridge** and steep for **12 hours**. Do not agitate during steeping.

Step 4 — Filter

After 12 hours, remove from the fridge and separate the grounds from the liquid using the brewer's built-in filter.

Step 5 — Serve

Pour the cold brew concentrate over **ice** in a glass. The cold brew is served as-is — no dilution, no additions.

Grind Size for Cold Brew

Cold brew requires a **coarse grind** (1000–1200 microns). On the Weber EG-1 v3, this corresponds to approximately dial **20–22**. The EG-1 v3 moves at 5 microns per click, 10 clicks per number, and 10 numbers per full rotation, covering a total range of 0–1400 microns. A grind that is too fine will produce an over-extracted, bitter, and astringent cold brew.

Standards & Consistency

Every drink at C+ is a reflection of our commitment to quality. Regardless of the recipe, the following principles apply to every drink you prepare:

- **Taste before serving.** If you would not drink it yourself, do not serve it.
- **Dial in at the start of every shift.** Espresso parameters drift throughout the day — check and adjust as needed.
- **Use fresh milk — but only what you need.** Never re-steam milk and discard leftovers between drinks, but minimise waste by estimating the correct amount before steaming. Excessive leftover milk is a sign of poor practice.
- **Keep your station clean.** Wipe the steam wand after every use. Purge the group head between shots. A clean workspace produces clean drinks.
- **Communicate.** If you run out of an ingredient, notice equipment issues, or see something that does not look right, speak up immediately.

This guide is a living document. As our menu evolves and our techniques improve, it will be updated. If you have suggestions or corrections, bring them to the head barista or management.

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